

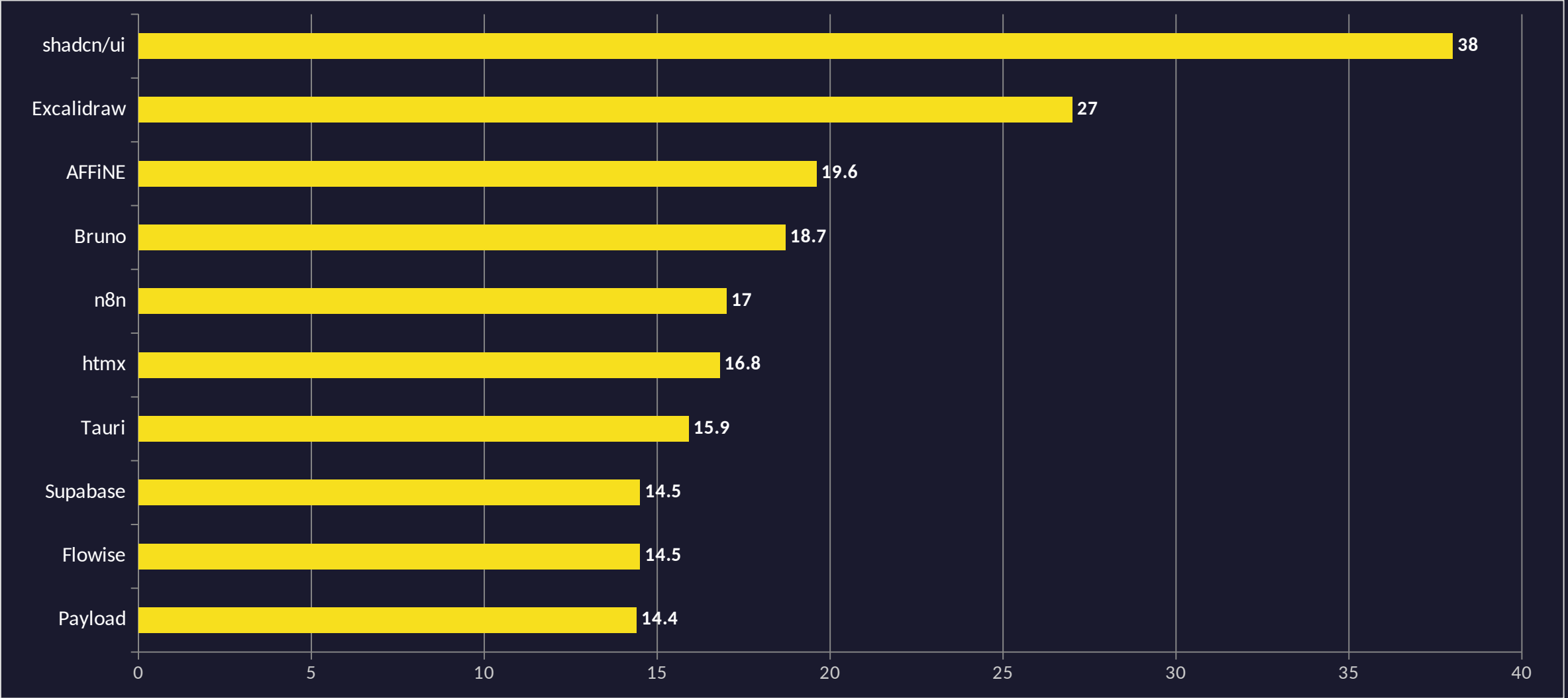
2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • GitHub stars added in 2024 • Curated by Best of JS

A data-driven overview of the most-starred JavaScript projects, highlighting the dominance of shadcn/ui, the rise of htmx, and major framework evolutions.

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en • Star counts represent GitHub stars added during calendar year 2024

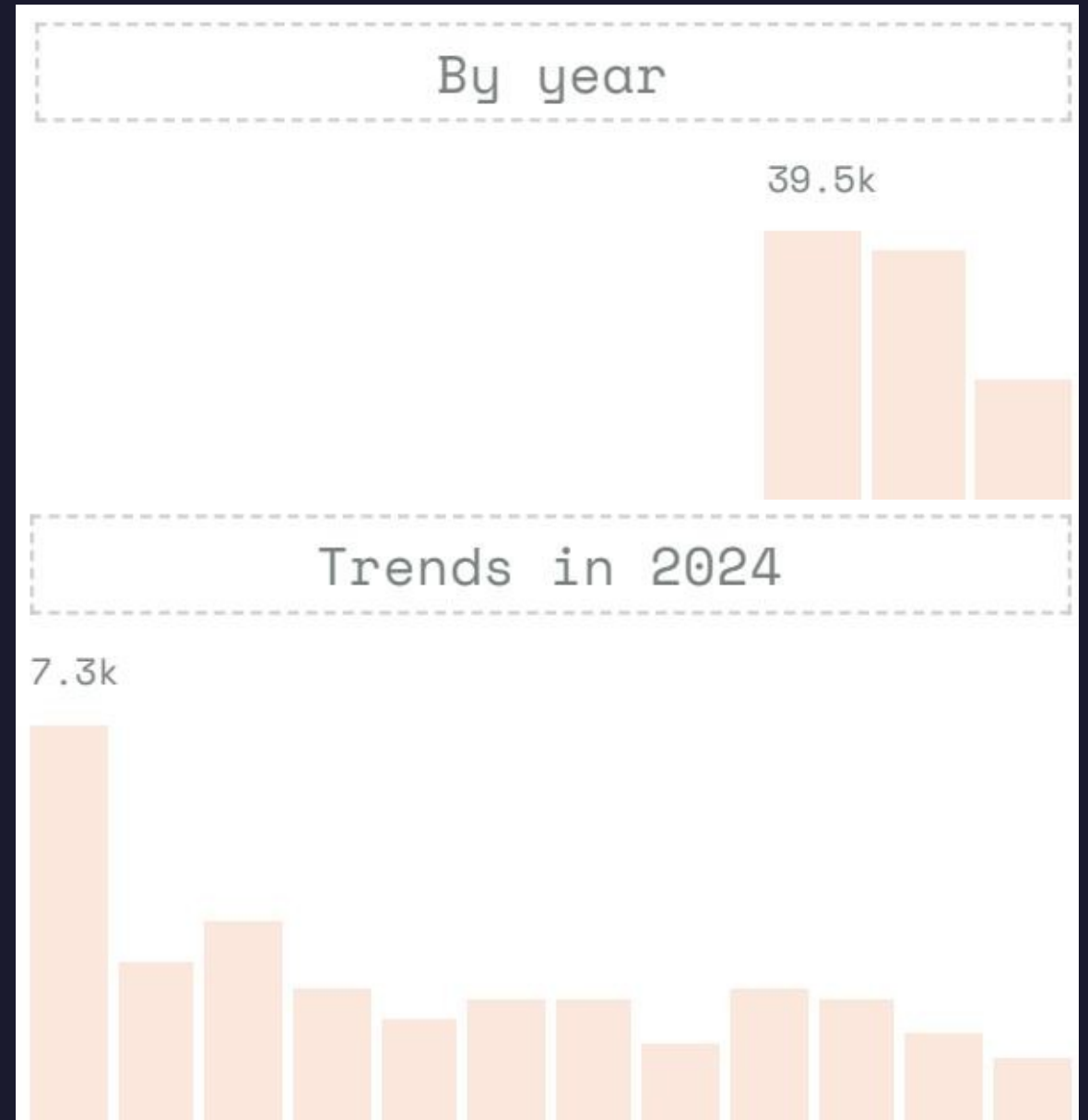
shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Year-over-Year Growth Trajectory

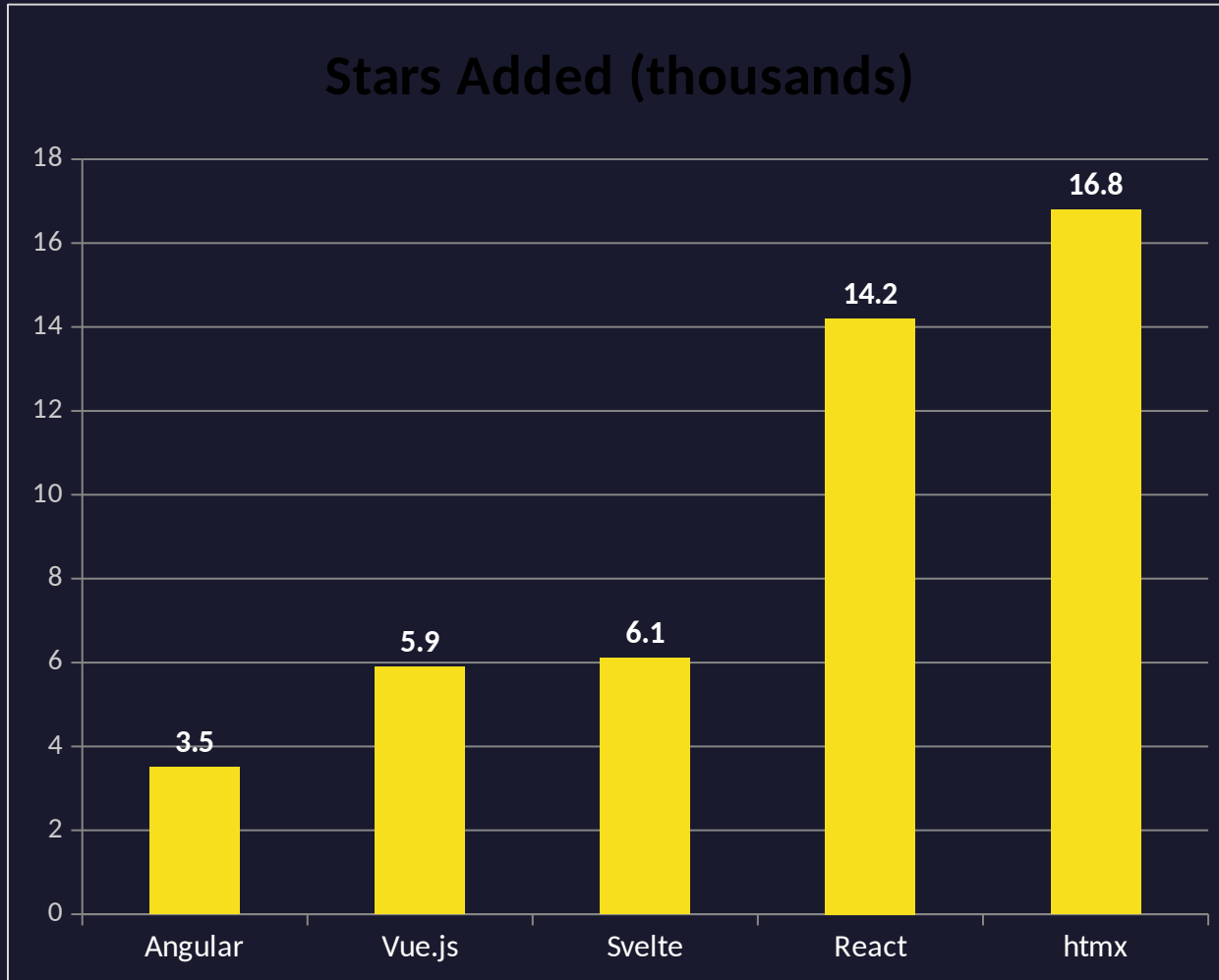
- 2016–2022: N/A (project did not exist)
- 2023: +39.5k stars (first year of tracking)
- 2024: +38.0k stars (sustained momentum)
- Total stars reached: 77.5k
- Created: January 2023

Key 2024 Additions

- Charts — powered by Recharts
- Themes — CSS variable generation
- Blocks — layout collections for web apps
- New responsive sidebar component
- Upgraded CLI — Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos
- Registry ecosystem — Motion-Primitives, Magic UI
- Vercel v0 integration — AI-generated components



htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx — HTML-First Interactivity

Extends HTML with `hx-*` attributes to enable data fetching and interactivity without writing JavaScript. Ideal for server-driven applications and progressive enhancement of static sites.

React 19 — Three Years in the Making

Launched December 2024 with Server Components, Server Functions, web component support, new hooks, and form actions. React is evolving from a library into 'a specification for frameworks.'

Svelte 5 — Runes for Reactivity

Introduced 'runes' — an explicit mechanism for declaring reactive state. Holds the highest positive opinion in the State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	shadcn/ui	+38.0k
2	Excalidraw	+27.0k
3	Payload	+14.4k
4	Magic UI	+13.2k
5	Next.js	+12.1k

React: From Library to Framework Specification

- React 19's Server Components and Server Functions
- Multiple frameworks now interpret React primitives differently
- Next.js, Remix, and others build on React's spec
- Client-only usage still supported, but framework-first is the direction
- React Compiler continues development for performance & DX

"React is evolving from a library into a specification for frameworks."

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	Nuxt	+6.2k
2	PrimeVue	+5.4k
3	Slidev	+4.7k
4	shadcn-vue	+4.1k
5	VitePress	+3.7k

Vue 3.5 and Ecosystem Maturity

- Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system
- 'alien-signals' approach landed in main branch
- Flourishing UI libraries: PrimeVue, shadcn-vue
- Signals growing ecosystem confidence
- Nuxt: active release cycle, regular performance improvements
- Daniel Roe (Nuxt core): committed to DX and speed

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Projects

n8n (+17.0k) — workflow automation with native AI
Flowise (+14.5k) — visual LLM flow building
Supabase (+14.5k) — open-source backend with AI features

Desktop & Mobile

Tauri (+15.9k) — lighter desktop/mobile apps
Built with web technologies (HTML/CSS/JS)
Smaller bundle sizes vs. Electron

Browser Innovation

PGlite — Postgres via WebAssembly
WebVM — virtual machine running entirely in browser
Pushing the edge of what's possible client-side

BaaS & Full-Stack

Supabase (+14.5k) — open-source Firebase alternative
AFFiNE (+19.6k) — knowledge base with Notion + Miro
Bruno (+18.7k) — open-source API testing IDE

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1

Component Ownership Beats Imports

shadcn/ui's model of letting developers own and customize component code proved its staying power for a second year, reaching 77.5k total stars.

2

HTML-First is Serious

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

3

React is Becoming a Framework Spec

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently.

4

AI Integration is Table Stakes

Four of the top 10 overall projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

5

Vue's Ecosystem Maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem.

Looking to 2025: Expect deeper AI integration, continued HTML-first adoption, and React's spec evolution to reshape how we build frontends.